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Citizens' Charter of Department of Posts

DISCLAIMER: *This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and the inclusion of recent changes, amendments, and updates to the relevant Acts, Rules, and Regulations, this document is intended as a study aid only. Readers and students are strongly recommended to refer to official government sources or gazettes for the most reliable and authoritative information.*

Citizens' Charter of Department of Posts

Our Vision

India Post's products and services will be the customer's first choice.

Mission

To sustain its position as the largest postal network in the world touching the lives of every citizen in the country.

- Ensuring customer satisfaction by providing services with speed, reliability and on value-for-money basis.
- To ensure that the employees serve their customers with a human touch.
- To continue to deliver social security services and to enable last mile connectivity as a Government of India platform.

Our Customers/Clients

- All individuals and corporate customers.
- Public Institutions, private businesses and media.
- Government organizations.
- Other postal administrations.

Our Services

Mails Services

- Letters, postcards, Inland letter cards, book packets, value payable post, parcels, Logistics Post, ePost, etc.
- Registration and insurance of postal articles and parcels covered by such facility.
- Premium mail services like Speed Post, Business Post, Business Parcel, Direct Post, Bill Mail Service, and Logistics Posts etc.
- Delivery services are provided by the designated delivery post offices and Branch Offices.

Financial Services

- Money Transfer - Money Order, Indian Postal Order, etc.
- Post Office Savings Bank- Small Savings Schemes and Savings Certificates.
- Postal Life Insurance and Rural Postal Life Insurance.

Philately

- Promotion of philately.
- Issue of definitive postage stamps.
- Issue of commemorative and special postage stamps.
- Delivery through Philatelic Bureau and counters as well as through ePost Office.

Counter Services

- Counter services are provided from post offices (Departmental and Branch Offices), Mail Offices or any other outlet designated for the purpose.
- These include:

- Sale of postage stamps and postal stationery, etc.
- Booking of registered insured, Speed Post, and other mail articles, etc.
- Booking of money orders, various transactions relating to Post Office Savings and Postal Life Insurance (PLI)/Rural Postal Life Insurance (RPLI), etc.
- ePost Office for anytime, anywhere transaction related to electronic money order, PLI Premium and philately products.

Service Standards of services provided by the Department of Posts (DOP)

A. Mails/Money Order

Time from posting / booking to delivery

1. Excludes: day of posting for articles booked after cut-off time, holidays & Sundays. adverse effect due to reasons beyond the control of DOP like curfew, bandh, strike, cancellation of means of transport or off-loading /non-carriage of mails by carriers and force majeure.
2. Article/MO booked/delivered in BOs will take **1 extra day**.
3. Standards apply to articles conforming to Gazette notification no: 486, dated **23.09.2013**(excluding MO), and bearing correct address & Pin code.

1.1 Delivery of First Class Mail (Letters, Postcards & Letter cards) & Registered Letter

- Local *: **2 Days**
- Metro-Metro*: **2-4 Days**
- State Capital to State Capital: **2-6 Days**
- Same state: **3-5 Days**

- Rest of the country: **5-6 Days**

1.2 Delivery of Speed Post articles

- Local*: **1-2 Days**
- Metro Metro: **1-3 Days**
- State Capital to State Capital: **1-4 Days**
- Same State: **1-4 Days**
- Rest of the country: **4-5 Days**

1.3 Delivery of Business Parcel & Second Class Mail (Parcel, Book packet, Registered Newspapers, Blind Literature packets)

- Local*: **3 Days**
- Metro-Metro**: **4-5 Days**
- State Capital to State Capital: **4-6 Days**
- Same State: **3-6 Days**
- Rest of the country: **6-7 Days**

Local and Metro Definitions: *Local shall mean: a. Articles booked and to be delivered within identified PIN codes-for Metro Cities. b. Articles booked and to be delivered within Municipality limit-for cities other than Metro cities. c. Articles booked and to be delivered within the same PIN code delivery jurisdiction- for Small Towns (Kasbas) or Mufussil areas having no defined town delivery area. ** Metro may be defined as municipal limits of the city w.r.t. Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Hyderabad and Bengaluru.

1.4 International EMS articles- All International Mail articles are subject to customs examination. Period for examination/ customs detention is not included in the service

standards. These are "End to End" delivery standards for Outbound articles booked in cities with OEs, i.e. Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai and Kochi. For articles booked at other locations, the timelines as per domestic speed post service standards will be added.

- Australia: **4-8 Days**
- Canada: **5-9 Days**
- China: **4-9 Days**
- France: **3-6 Days**
- Japan: **4-8 Days**
- Malaysia: **3-7 Days**
- Russia: **5-9 Days**
- Saudi Arabia: **4-8 Days**
- Singapore: **3-6 Days**
- South Korea: **3-7 Days**
- Taiwan: **3-6 Days**
- UAE: **4-8 Days**
- United Kingdom (UK): **2-6 Days**
- United States of America: **4-7 Days** **List of countries attached below*

B. Financial Services

Money Remittance Time from booking to transfer / payment

2.1 Delivery of Money Order

- Local* and between Metro Cities**: **2 Working Days**
 - * Local - within Municipal City limits
 - ** Metro- Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai, Hyderabad and Bengaluru.
- Rest of India: **4 Working Days**

2.2 International Money Transfer Service (Payments of instant Inward remittances received through Money Transfer operators like Western Union) (Service available at specified offices)

- Payment on production of code and required documents.: **10 Minutes**

3 (a) Post Office Savings Bank (The standards apply to non CBS Post Offices only)

3.1 Opening of account, closing of account, withdrawal and deposit.

- Please see Counter Services.

Transfer of Accounts (Please collect dated receipt)

- Within the same Head Post Office: **1 Working Day**
- From one Head Post Office to another Head Post Office: **7 Working Days**
- Requested at the transferee post office: **15 Days**

3.2 Settlement of customer requests for: -

- i). Deceased claims (after receipt of complete documents)
 - a). Where nomination exists: **1 Working Day**

- b). Where no nomination exists: **7 Working Days**
- ii). Issue of Duplicate Passbook: **7 Working Days**
- iii). Interest Posting: **1 Working Day**

3.3 Discharge of Savings Certificates at post office other than the office of purchase

- Time taken from the receipt of application for discharge of certificates at the post office.: **30 Working Days**

3.4 Transfer of Savings Certificate

- Time taken from the receipt of application for transfer at the post office.: **30 Working Days**

3.5 Issue of Duplicate Certificate

- i). Certificate issued before **01.07.2016** (Time taken from the receipt of application along with required documents at the post office of issue of the certificate): **15 Working Day/Days**
- ii). Certificate issued on or after **01.07.2016**
 - Presented at HO: **1 Days**
 - Presented at SO: **7 Days**

3.(b) Post Office Savings Bank (The standards apply to CBS Post Offices only)

3.1.1 Transfer of Accounts (Please collect dated receipt)

- Request at any Head Post Office: **1 Working Day**

3.1.2 Deceased claim with nomination

- Request at any Sub Post Office: **3 Working Days**
- If presented at Head Post Office (HO) or Sub Post Office (SO): **1 Working Day**

3.1.3 Deceased claim without nomination

- If presented at HO or SO and within powers of HO or SO: **1 Working Day**
- If beyond powers of HO or SO and within powers of Divisional Heads: **7 Working Days**

3.1.4 Issue of Duplicate Passbook

- When presented at HO: **1 Working Day**
- When presented at any SO(due to physical movement of application from SO to its HO and vice versa): **7 Working Days**

3.1.5 Interest Posting

- **1 Working Day (Same Day)**

3.1.6 Discharge of Savings Certificates at post office other than the office of purchase after transfer of certificate

- Payment request at HO: **1 Working Day**
- Payment request at SO (cash/transfer to savings account): **1 Working Day**
- Payment request at SO (cheque): **3 Working Days**

3.1.7 Transfer of Certificates (Please collect dated receipt)

- Request at HO: **1 Working Day**
- Request at SO: **3 Working Days**

3.1.8 Issue of Duplicate Certificate

- Requested at any Sub Post Office in physical form issued before **01.07.2016**: **3 Working Days**

- i). Certificate issued before **01.07.2016** (Time taken from the receipt of application along with required documents at the post office of issue of the certificate): **15 Working Day/Days**
- ii). Certificate issued on or after **01.07.2016**
 - Presented at HO: **1 Working Day/Days**
 - Presented at SO: **7 Working Day/Days**

3.1.9 Opening of Account/Purchase of saving certificates (after clearance of cheque)

- **1 Working Day**

3.1.10 Closure of Account

- If account closed at HO: **1 Working Day**
- If account closed at SO (for payment by cash/transfer to savings account): **1 Working Day**
- If account closed at SO (for payment by cheque): **3 Working Days**

3.1.11 Issue of ATM card (Insta) (after receipt of complete application/documents)

- **1 Working Day**

3.1.12 Issue of ATM Card (Personalized)

- **30 Days**

3.1.13 Enabling ebanking/mbanking (after receipt of complete application/documents)

- **1 Working day**

C. Postal Life Insurance and Rural Postal Life Insurance

- **4.1 Issue of acceptance Letter / Issue of Policy Bond:** Time taken from the receipt of completed documents is **15 Days**.
- **4.2 Maturity claim settlement/Paid up value of policy/Survival Benefit payment:** Time taken from the receipt of completed documents is **15 Days**.
- **4.3 Settlement of PLI/RPLI death claims:**
 - With/Without nomination (Time taken from the receipt of completed documents): **30 Days**.
 - Involving investigation: **90 Days**.
- **4.4 Revival of policy / Conversion of policy:** Time taken from receipt of completed documents is **15 Days**.
- **4.5 Time taken for settlement on receipt of request:**
 - (i) Loan against policies: **10 Days**.
 - (ii) Change of address: **5 Days**.
 - (iii) Change of nomination: **10 Days**.
 - (iv) Assignment of policy: **10 Days**.
 - (v) Issue of duplicate policy bond: **10 Days**.

5. Counter Services

- Counter Services (excluding waiting time in queue): **2-5 Minutes**.
- **5.1 Sale of Philatelic stamps and items: 1 Same Day**.

6. Service Standards of various services for Branch Office

- **6.1 Transactions for which the Branch Office is authorized:** Transaction Time at Branch Office - Sale of Stamps and stationery, Miscellaneous Services is **3 Minutes**.
- **6.2 Booking of Registered Articles, Booking of Money Orders, Collection and Payment of PLI premia, Post Office Savings Bank Deposit & withdrawal:** Transaction Time at Branch Office is **10 Minutes**.

7. Transaction which are required to be authorized / routed through the Account Office

- **7.1 Transaction of all nine schemes which are required to be authorized/ routed through the Account Office:** **6 days** in addition to the relevant service standards declared for authorized Branch Offices.

8. Service Standards of Public Grievance Redress

- **8.1 Issue of Acknowledgement of complaint:** On the day of receipt itself (Instantaneous in case of web registration) / **1 Day**.
- **8.2 Settlement of Complaints:** Time from lodging of complaint is **60 Days**.
- **8.3 Settlement of complaint in cases requiring investigation:** Time from lodging of complaint is **90 Days**.

D. Miscellaneous

D.1 Reasonable expectations from Service Recipients

1. Mails

- **1.1** Address of addressee and sender should contain House Number, Name of Street, City, District, State and Pin Code. Name of village of addressee and the name of the delivery Branch Office of the addressee. Phone number of the sender and addressee (optional).
- **1.2** Packaging Tips:
<https://www.indiapost.gov.in/MBE/Pages/Content/Packaging-Tips.aspx>
- **1.3** Prohibited Articles by Post:
<https://www.indiapost.gov.in/MBE/Pages/Content/Prohibited-Articles.aspx>
- **1.4** To affix correct amount of postage on mail articles.
- **1.5** To provide Mail Box on the ground floor for each address in the multi storied building.
- **1.6** To notify the delivery post office of the change of address and provide the forwarding address.
- **1.7** To give proper authorization to representative for receiving delivery of registered, insured, money orders and Speed Post etc. in absence.

2. Money Order/Mails Services

- **2.1** To cooperate by producing ID on demand by Postmen or at the counter.
- **2.2** To insist on obtaining receipts for articles and money orders booked.

3. Savings Bank / Cash Certificate/Insurance Services

- **3.1** To provide Know Your Customer (KYC) documents as prescribed.

- **3.2** To check the Agency Number, Authorization and validity of the Small Savings and Postal Life Insurance Agents and Rural Postal Life Insurance Agents before carrying out any transactions with them.
- **3.3** To keep pass book updated and secure. Obtain receipt if passbook is handed over to the post office. Check that the last balance in the Pass Book matches with that written in the receipt.
- **3.4** To make nominations for all Post Office Savings Bank Accounts, Savings Certificates, Postal Life Insurance and Rural Postal Life Insurance.

4. Financial Services

- **4.1** Not to disclose the code number/Secret code of instant money order communicated by the Post Office to any person other than the recipient/s.

5. Savings Bank / Cash Certificate/Postal Life Insurance Services

- **5.1** To collect receipt when handing over requests for transfer or deceased claim cases.

6. General / Public Grievance Redress Services

- **6.1** To lodge a complaint within **60 days** of the transaction/availing of a service, relating to any deficiency in service.
- **6.2** Request to be specific while registering complaint/query.
- **6.3** Ensure that postal services are not used for money laundering, financing of terrorism, smuggling or any other fraudulent or illegal activity.

D.2 Grievance Redress Mechanism (GRM) in the Department of Posts

1. When to lodge the complaints:

- Complaints are to be lodged within **60 days** of the transaction / availing of a service.

- Complaints like claims and customer requests for Post Office Savings Bank, Savings Certificate, Postal Life Insurance and Rural Postal Life Insurance are to be lodged after the number of days in the prescribed service standard is over.

2. Where to lodge the Complaints:

- Complaints and Suggestion Book for complaints pertaining to services in the post office in particular or for giving suggestions for improvement. Complaints and Suggestion Book is available in all post offices and is required to be given to customer when demanded.
- Complaints relating to any deficiency in service can be lodged:
 - Online at www.indiapost.gov.in or pgportal.gov.in/
 - Dial India Post Call Centre (1800 266 6868) & tweet @indiapostoffice.
 - By hand or by Post at: Post Office where transaction took place, Office of Senior Superintendent of Post Offices/ Superintendent of Posts Offices, At any Post Office.
- For Value Payable articles complaints are to be lodged at the office of booking.

3. How to lodge complaints:

- Complaints for PLI /RPLI can be handed or posted to the Deputy Divisional Manager (PLI/RPLI) stationed at each Circle Office headquarters and Development Officer (PLI).
- Online complaints require filling up of the forms to capture all the details.
- In other cases complete information needs to be given with reference to the transaction, service failure and proof of transaction.

4. Acknowledgement of Complaints:

- Complaints lodged on the web will be acknowledged instantaneously.

- Complaints handed in person at the Customer Care Centre will be acknowledged at the time of handing.
- In other cases acknowledgement will be sent on the day of receipt itself.

5. Time for redress:

- **60 days** (if delay is expected an interim reply within **60 days** to follow indicating the reason for delay and additional time required for redress).
- Complaints requiring investigations (Interim reply may be given) - **90 days**.

6. Escalation of complaints not redressed within stipulated time:

- In case the complaint is not redressed in time or to the satisfaction of the customer the complaint may be taken up with the Postmaster General of the Region or the Chief Postmaster General of the Circle.

7. Nodal officers for handling grievances at HQ level:

- DDG (PG), Department of Posts, Dak Bhavan, New Delhi. **110001** (other than PLI).
ddgpgq@indiapost.gov.in
- General Manager (Business & Investments), Directorate of Postal Life Insurance, Chanakyapuri Post Office Complex, New Delhi-**110023**. (For complaints relating to PLI/RPLI) gmo.pli@indiapost.gov.in

International EMS Articles - Service Standards

No.	Qualifying Description	Service Standards (Days)*
1	Afghanistan	3-7
2	Argentina	5-9
3	Australia	4-8
4	Austria	4-8
5	Bahrain	4-8
6	Bangladesh	3-7
7	Barbados	5-9
8	Belarus	5-9
9	Belgium	4-8
10	Bermuda	5-9
11	Bhutan	3-7
12	Bosnia and Herzegovina	5-9
13	Botswana	6-9
14	Brazil	5-9
15	Brunei Dar Ussalam	3-7
16	Bulgaria	5-9
17	Cambodia	3-6
18	Canada	5-9
19	Cape Verde	6-9
20	Cayman Islands	5-9
21	China	4-9
22	Cuba	5-9
23	Cyprus	5-9
24	Democratic Republic of Congo	6-9
25	Denmark	4-8
26	Ecuador	5-9
27	Egypt	6-9
28	El Salvador	5-9
29	Eritrea	6-9

30	Estonia	5-9
31	Ethiopia	6-9
32	Fiji	4-9
33	Finland	4-8
34	France	4-8
35	Georgia	2-6
36	Germany	4-8
37	Ghana	6-9
38	Greece	5-9
39	Guyana	5-9
40	Hong kong	3-6
41	Hungary	3-7
42	Iceland	4-8
43	Indonesia	3-7
44	Iran	4-9
45	Iraq	4-9
46	Ireland	4-8
47	Israel	4-9
48	Italy	4-8
49	Japan	3-6
50	Jordan	4-9
51	Kazakhstan	5-9
52	Kenya	6-9
53	Kuwait	4-8
54	Latvia	5-9
55	Lithuania	5-9
56	Luxamberg	4-8
57	Macau	4-9
58	Malawi	6-9
59	Malaysia	3-7
60	Maldives	3-7

61	Mauritius	6-9
62	Mexico	5-9
63	Mongolia	4-9
64	Morocco	6-9
65	Namibia	6-9
66	Nauru	4-9
67	Nepal	3-7
68	Netherland	4-8
69	New Zealand	4-8
70	Niger	6-9
71	Nigeria	6-9
72	North Macedonia	5-9
73	Norway	4-8
74	Oman	4-8
75	Pakistan	3-7
76	Panama	5-9
77	Papua New Guinea	4-9
78	Philippines	3-7
79	Poland	5-9
80	Portugal	4-8
81	Qatar	4-8
82	Romania	4-8
83	Russia	5-9
84	Rwanda	6-9
85	Saudi Arabia	4-8
86	Senegal	6-9
87	Singapore	3-6
88	South Africa	6-9
89	South Korea	3-7
90	Spain	4-8
91	Sri Lanka	3-7

92	Sudan	6-9
93	Sweden	4-8
94	Switzerland	4-8
95	Taiwan	3-6
96	Tanzania	6-9
97	Thailand	3-6
98	Tunisia	6-9
99	Turkey	3-6
100	UAE	4-8
101	Uganda	6-9
102	Ukraine	5-9
103	United Kingdom	2-6
104	USA	4-7
105	Vietnam	3-7
106	Yaman	4-8

***Note:** International EMS articles - All international mail articles are subject to customs examination. Period for customs examination / detention is not included in the service standards. These are "End to End" delivery standards for outbound articles booked in cities with OEs, i.e. Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, Chennai And Kochi. For articles booked at other locations the timelines as per domestics speed post service standards will be added.